ShopEase Promotions, Sales, and Loyalty Knowledge Base (KB)

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Last Updated: June 2026

Classification: Internal Confidential

1. Major Sales Events (ShopEase Big Sale)

1.1 Overview and Festival Policies

ShopEase runs major sale events throughout the year, prominently during festival seasons (Diwali, Holi, Christmas) and independent tentpole events (e.g., ShopEase Big Sale, Summer Blockbuster).

- **Elevated Demand Policies:** During major sales, standard SLAs for delivery and support response times may be temporarily extended due to extreme volume. Agents must set correct expectations regarding delivery timelines.
- **Inventory Rules:** All items during sale events are sold on a "first-come, first-served" basis. Placing an item in the cart does not reserve the inventory. An item is only secured once payment is successfully authorized.

1.2 Early Access for Plus Members

- **Benefit:** Customers subscribed to the "ShopEase Plus" membership program receive "Early Access" to major sales, typically 12 to 24 hours before the sale opens to general users.
- **Agent Action:** If a non-Plus member complains about products being out of stock before the sale officially begins, agents must politely explain that Plus members had early access and encourage them to subscribe for future events.

2. Flash Sales (Lightning Deals)

2.1 Rules of Engagement

Flash sales offer deep discounts on limited inventory for a very short duration.

- **Time Limit:** Deals are usually active for 1 to 4 hours.
- **Quantity Limits:** Customers are strictly limited to purchasing **one unit per account/household** of any flash sale item to prevent reseller hoarding.
- **Cart Expiry:** Once added to the cart, the customer has exactly **15 minutes** to complete checkout. If checkout is not completed, the item returns to the flash sale pool, and the price reverts to standard.

2.2 Common Flash Sale Inquiries

- **"The deal disappeared from my cart":** The 15-minute checkout window expired, or the entire inventory was claimed before checkout completion.
- **"I couldn't checkout due to a payment failure":** If the failure occurred during the checkout process and the deal inventory ran out in the meantime, ShopEase cannot reinstate the deal price.

3. Coupons and Promo Codes

3.1 Coupon Usage Rules

- **Eligibility:** Coupons are often account-specific, category-specific, or have minimum order value requirements.
- **Coupon Stacking Policy:** ShopEase strictly **prohibits coupon stacking**. Customers can only apply **one (1)** promo code per order. The system will automatically apply the coupon that offers the highest discount if the customer tries to enter multiple.
- **Exclusions:** Standard coupons do not apply to Gold/Silver coins, baby food, gift cards, or products already under Flash Sales.

3.2 Troubleshooting Coupon Issues

1. **"Coupon Not Applied / Invalid Code":**
   - Verify the coupon's exact spelling (case-sensitive).
   - Check the expiration date and time.
   - Confirm the cart meets the minimum order value.
   - Ensure the items in the cart are eligible (not on the exclusion list).
2. **"Code says already used":** Check the customer's order history. If they cancelled an order where the code was used, the code may take up to 24 hours to reactivate for their account.

4. ShopEase Wallet and Cashback

4.1 ShopEase Wallet Operations

The ShopEase Wallet holds promotional credits, specific refunds, and earned cashback.

- **Validity:** Promotional Wallet credits and cashback usually expire **90 days** from the date of issue unless stated otherwise in specific campaign terms. Refund amounts deposited to the wallet (at customer request) never expire.
- **Usage Limit:** Customers can pay for up to 100% of an order value using their wallet balance, provided it does not cover shipping fees or cash-on-delivery charges.

4.2 Troubleshooting Cashback Not Credited

1. **Check Offer Terms:** Verify if the cashback was tied to a specific payment method (e.g., "10% Cashback on HDFC Credit Cards").
2. **Credit Timeline:** Promotional cashback is typically credited **72 hours after successful delivery** (not at the time of order placement), to prevent fraud through immediate cancellations.

3. **Return/Cancellation:** If the order was returned or cancelled, the cashback offer is voided.

5. Loyalty Points System (EasePoints)

5.1 Earning EasePoints

- **Standard Rate:** Customers earn 1 EasePoint for every ₹100 spent on eligible items.
- **Bonus Points:** Multipliers (e.g., 2X points) may apply during special events or for specific categories.

5.2 Redeeming EasePoints

- **Value:** 10 EasePoints = ₹1.
- **Redemption:** Points can be applied at checkout as a direct discount.
- **Expiry:** EasePoints expire on December 31st of the year *following* the year they were earned (e.g., points earned in March 2025 expire Dec 31, 2026).

6. Referral Program

6.1 Referral Rules

- **Mechanism:** Existing customers share a unique referral link.
- **Reward:** When a new user signs up using the link and successfully completes their first delivered order (minimum value ₹500), both the referrer and the referee receive ₹100 in ShopEase Wallet Credit.
- **Fraud Prevention:** Self-referrals (using the same device ID, IP address, or payment method to create multiple accounts) are flagged by the Trust & Safety AI. Rewards are withheld, and accounts may be suspended as per the Account Ban Policy.

7. Price Drop Protection Policy

7.1 Policy Overview

ShopEase operates a dynamic pricing model. **We do not offer a formal Price Drop Protection guarantee or retroactive refunds for price adjustments.**

7.2 Handling Price Difference Complaints

- If a customer complains that an item they bought yesterday is now cheaper today (especially common around sale events):
    - Politely explain the dynamic nature of marketplace pricing and promotional events.
    - **Refer to Exceptions:** While formal price matching is not offered, agents should refer to the **"Price Difference Refund After Purchase"** exception protocol (outlined in the *Customer Support Knowledge Base*) to determine if a small goodwill wallet credit is appropriate as a retention tool, strictly to prevent an unnecessary return.